

ARCHITECTURAL / 2020 / CHICAGO, IL

Pritzker Group Reception Desk

Bronze clad desk and credenza



Bronze clad reception desk and bronze framed credenza for the Pritzker Group offices.

THE WORK

A bronze clad reception desk and bronze framed credenza for the Pritzker Group offices. Bronze is a little bit of a power play, a statement of refined sensibility, and for a financial firm it balances old and new: set against the bright red feature wall behind it, the desk asserts value and taste while staying clean, welcoming, even fun.

THE MATERIAL QUESTION

Cladding a desk in bronze leaves no room for error. The seams have to be tight and precise, and the metal has to meet a body built by someone else.

THE MAKING

Developed with Imperial Woodworking and Lazuli Studio under Gensler's direction. We had the desk body in our shop while we prepared the cladding, and that is the only reason the work could be so precise: shims glued in at every gap so every measurement held, and some bronze pieces hand cut and beveled on the table saw by Ben Stagl to make the fit.

IN PLACE

Installing the cladding on a busy union site, as a small specialist team not used to working that way, was its own challenge. The precision done in the shop is what made it go in clean.

DETAILS

Year

2020

Location

Chicago, IL

Category

Architectural

Materials

Bronze, patina, hardwood

CREDITS

Direction: Gensler

With Imperial Woodworking and Lazuli Studio

STUDIO

ChiLab Studio

Chicago, Illinois

Established 2013





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Bring us a drawing, a model, or a hunch.

THE STUDIO

Specialty material projects for architecture, interior design, public art, and the fine arts.

ChiLab Studio, Chicago, Illinois. Established 2013.

WHAT WE DO

Metal casting

Glass

Finishes

Digital fabrication

Metal fabrication

Restoration

Project management

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